Abdullah Al Zahid

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October 28, 2026

Hiring Manager
Operational Planning & Interface Management, Capital Projects Group
Metrolinx

Re: Project Manager, Permit, Licenses & Approvals

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Project Manager, Permit, Licenses & Approvals position. I worked at Metrolinx in 2023 as a Transportation Planner in Service Design, and since January 2024 I have been an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto.

At the City I sit on the approval-authority side of the process the posting describes. I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, recommend conditions where something is missing, and advise on by-laws and regulations. I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on. I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, holding the schedule myself, and I know the Planning Act process from the City's side. At Mott MacDonald I worked on road-closure traffic simulation for Ontario Line construction staging, so I have seen what a construction schedule has to get past before a road can be closed. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not prepared or tracked permit applications for a construction project, or dealt with the Environmental Assessment Act and O. Reg. 231/08, the Ontario Water Resources Act or heritage approvals. I have not worked with design-build delivery or contract administration, and I have not negotiated with approval authorities on a project's behalf. My experience is with the municipal side of review, and I would need to learn the construction side.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,



Abdullah Al Zahid